MBA Target Score Planner: School Shortlist & Score Goal Worksheet

Business School Shortlist Matrix, GMAT Focus 205-805 Scoring Bands & Profile Weighting Calculator

1. Top Global & Indian MBA Score Targets (GMAT Focus Edition 2026/2027)

Benchmark your target score using official median, middle 80% ranges, and competitive thresholds for premier business schools on the 205-805 scale.

Business School & Program	Median Score (Focus)	Competitive 80% Range	Recommended Candidate Target
Stanford Graduate School of Business (GSB)	715 (99th %ile)	675 – 755	735+ (99.8th percentile for competitive pools)
Harvard Business School (HBS)	705 (99th %ile)	665 – 745	725+ (Balanced 82+ in all 3 sections)
Wharton (University of Pennsylvania)	705 (99th %ile)	665 – 755	715+ (Strong Quant 84+ emphasis)
INSEAD (Fontainebleau / Singapore)	675 (94th %ile)	635 – 725	685+ (70th+ percentile in all 3 sections required)
London Business School (LBS)	685 (96th %ile)	645 – 735	695+ (High global applicant diversity focus)
Indian School of Business (ISB PGP)	665 (91st %ile)	625 – 715	685+ (For Indian Male Engineers: 705+)
Northwestern Kellogg & Chicago Booth	705 (99th %ile)	655 – 745	715+ (Strong analytical & DI profile)
Columbia Business School & MIT Sloan	705 (99th %ile)	665 – 745	715+ (Emphasis on Quant / Data Insights 83+)
NUS / NTU Singapore & HKUST	655 (88th %ile)	615 – 695	665+ (Strong regional placement pedigree)
Top US Tier-2 (Tepper, McCombs, Kenan-Flagler)	645 (85th %ile)	595 – 685	665+ (Maximizes merit scholarship eligibility)

Note: On GMAT Focus, a score of 685 equals ~730 on the legacy scale; 705 equals ~750 legacy; 735 equals ~770 legacy.

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2. Profile Strength & Diversity Adjustment Matrix

Calculate how your background influences your real-world target score compared to school class medians.

Applicant Profile Segment	Admissions Pool Density	Score Adjustment Needed	Strategic Priority Focus
Over-Represented Pool (e.g. Indian Tech/Engineer Male)	Extremely High (>40% of applicants)	Median + 30 to 40 Points (Aim 705-735)	Flawless Quant (86+) & compelling non-work leadership narrative
Corporate Finance / Investment Banking	High Competitive Pool	Median + 10 to 20 Points (Aim 685-715)	Demonstrate high Data Insights & executive communication in Verbal
Management Consulting (MBB / Big 4)	High Competitive Pool	Median Score (~675-705)	High balanced percentiles; articulate differentiated sector focus
Under-Represented Profiles (Humanities, Arts, Non-Profit)	Low Pool Density	Median – 20 to +10 Points (Aim 645-685)	Must show Quant readiness (Quant 80+) to alleviate academic doubt
Women in Business / STEM Initiatives	High Institutional Priority	School Median (~665-695)	Leadership track record & bold career trajectory vision
Second MBA / Senior Executives (EMBA/One-Year)	Moderate Pool Density	Median Score or Executive Assessment	Significant managerial P&L impact & strategic team oversight

Worksheet Rule: Set your stretch target at median + 30 points and your safe target at the school median score.

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3. 90-Day Score Shortlist & Milestone Worksheet

Step-by-step framework to finalize your 3-tier school shortlist (Dream, Target, Safety) and lock in test deadlines.

- Dream Schools (2 Schools): Average Focus median 715+. Require stretch prep and exceptional storytelling essays.
- Target Schools (3 Schools): Your diagnostic / expected score matches or exceeds their median by 10-20 points.
- Safety Schools (2 Schools): Your projected score sits comfortably in the upper 80th percentile; strong scholarship probability.
- Milestone 1 (Day 1-30): Foundation mastery across Quant arithmetic/algebra, Verbal CR logic, and DI graph literacy.
- Milestone 2 (Day 31-60): High-volume timed drills, 4-bucket error logging, and sectional score stabilization at 80+.
- Milestone 3 (Day 61-90): 6 Official GMAC adaptive practice mocks, question review pacing audit, and test-day booking.